

Protocol for Suicide/Attempted Suicide Calls:

CALL FROM A THIRD PARTY:

- 1) Get the caller's name, call back number, location/specific location.
- 2) Get the name, sex, age, location/specific location of the person in need of assistance
- 3) Gather situational information:
 - a. Is the patient conscious, breathing (breathing normally), bleeding, alert/oriented (can they tell you their name, where they are)
 - b. Did the patient do anything to harm themselves (bodily injury, ingestion of anything)
 - c. Ask if emergency assistance is needed.
- 4) Keep the caller on the line and ask them to stay with the patient until officers arrive.
- 5) Dispatch all units to the area "Dispatch to all units, there is a 10-97 (ideation/attempt) in the (location/specific location) give additional information (patient is conscious, breathing, bleeding ...) advise if emergency response requested (EMS requested, dispatch will be on the line with EMS)*repeat)
- 6) Notify the caller that units are en-route, and get an update of the patient's status (notify officers if there is a change in status)
- 7) EMS requested:
 - a. Notify the caller that you will be on the line with EMS, and to advise if the patient's status changes
 - b. Call 911 advise them that you are Calvin College Campus Safety Dispatch and you need medical assistance to (give location for EMS to respond to where officers will escort them in). Pass on the medical information (patients age, sex, medical symptoms).
 - c. Notify EMS if emergency assistance is needed for medical, or if non-emergency transport is needed for a psychiatric evaluation (request that they come no lights/no sirens for a psych eval)
 - d. Notify officers when off the line with EMS, and that that they are en-route.
 - e. Record all times in CAD.

- 8) EMS NOT needed
 - a. Gather additional medical information from the caller. (ask if the patient states that they want to end their life, if they have a plan to, if they have a history of feeling this way, and if they are on any current medications)
 - b. Notify officers of any additional information
- 9) Call the RD on call to advise of the patient's situation, and if they are going to be transported for a psychiatric evaluation or if they are going to be transported to the hospital for medical care.
- 10) Record all information in CAD under the call type 'suicide-attempt'

CALL FROM THE PERSON HAVING SUICIDAL THOUGHTS/ATTEMPT:

- 1) Get the caller's name, call back number, location/specific location.
 - a. Use the caller's first name when talking to them in a calm tone
- 2) Gather situational information:
 - a. Ask the caller if they have any desire to end their life.
 - b. Ask the caller if they did anything to harm themselves, or if they have a plan to harm themselves.
 - i. Yes: Ask what they did (bodily injury, ingestion of anything, what they ingested/how many/how long ago) are they bleeding, alert/oriented (can they tell you their name, where they are), are they having trouble breathing.
 - c. Ask if they have any weapons in their possession.
- 3) Keep the caller on the line put the call on Mute and advise officers
- 4) Dispatch all units to the area "Dispatch to all units, there is a 10-97 (ideation/attempt) in the (location/specific location) give additional information (patient is conscious, breathing, bleeding ...) advise if emergency response requested (EMS requested, dispatch will be on the line with EMS)*repeat)
- 5) Notify the caller that an officer is able to meet with them to help, and ask if they are willing to talk with them.
 - a. If the caller says that they do not want to talk to an officer, if they become

agitated or aggressive, or if they disconnect the call, immediately notify the officers

- 6) Tell the caller that it is brave of them to call, that they are not alone, and officers will be there soon to help.
 - a. Ask the caller if they have a history of having suicidal feelings, history of depression or anxiety, or taking any current medications. Update officers on any information received via cell phone.
- 7) EMS requested: (by officer, caller, or if their symptoms warrant automatic call for EMS)
 - a. Notify the caller that you will be on the line with EMS, and that you can hear them if they need to tell you anything
 - b. Call 911 advise them that you are Calvin College Campus Safety Dispatch and you need medical assistance to (give location for EMS to respond to where officers will escort them in). Pass on the medical information (patients age, sex, medical symptoms).
 - c. Notify EMS if emergency assistance is needed for medical, or if non-emergency transport is needed for a psychiatric evaluation (request that they come no lights/no sirens for a psych eval)
 - d. Notify officers when off the line with EMS, and that that they are en-route.
 - e. Record all times in CAD.
- 8) Call the RD on call to advise of the patient's situation, and if they are going to be transported for a psychiatric evaluation or if they are going to be transported to the hospital for medical care.
- 9) Record all information in CAD under the call type 'suicide-attempt'

If any call is received stating that a 10-97 was completed and there is a death investigation, notify officers immediately. Do not say 'death or dead' on the radio, say "Dispatch to all units, there is a 10-97 completion in the (location/specific location) additional information will be passed via cellphone. Dispatch will be on the line with EMS*repeat). Call the supervisor cell phone and advise of all information received on the deceased patient. Notify EMS, 9901, RD on-call, and the correct college official contact listed below depending on a Calvin student, Seminary student, or Staff/Faculty. Record all information in CAD as a 'death investigation'.